

DESCRIPTION AND SYLLABUS

Name of the subject in Hungarian:	Motion Typography
Name of the subject in English:	Motion Typography
Credit value of the subject:	5
The code of the subject in the electronic study system:	BN-MOTYPG-05-GY
Classification of the subject:	Optional
Language of instruction (in case of non-Hungarian courses):	English
Institute or department responsible for the subject:	-
The instructor responsible for the subject:	Melinda Kiss
Other instructor(s) involved in the teaching of the subject:	Csomor Lilla Lúcia
Course type and number of contact hours:	Practical, class per week: 4, class per semester: 0
Mode of study: (Full-time / Part-time):	Full-time training
The semester in which the subject is open for registration:	2025/2026 2nd semester
Prerequisite(s):	-

THE PURPOSE OF THE SUBJECT, LEARNING OUTCOMES:

The aim of the course is to provide students from different disciplinary backgrounds with competitive skills that support their chosen professions and elevate the quality of their professional work. Through the competencies acquired during the course, students will be able to apply complex design, research, and presentation methods.

Animated typography has become an increasingly important expressive tool in contemporary digital media. The course offers an introduction to the fundamentals of digital display and typographic motion, adapted to the specific characteristics of various communication platforms. Students gain foundational knowledge in type history and typography, as well as an understanding of the aesthetic, dramaturgical, and informational roles of dynamic typography, followed by its applications in moving image formats.

The course aims to develop an integrated perspective on the cultural, stylistic, and technical aspects of moving image typography. Students will be able to analyze moving image works and design and realize their own typographic concepts. During the course, they acquire practical skills in using Adobe After Effects, enabling them to create animated typography creatively and efficiently, while also gaining a valuable advantage in the job market.

COMPETENCES:

At least 3 course-relevant basic competences the subject aims to develop:
Complex problem solving
Creativity
Digital competences

Competences in accordance with the programme completion and exit requirements:

Knowledge (by completing the subject, the student will learn and understand the following):
The student understands the main differences in the operation and process of analytical, creative and intuitive way of thinking and is aware of the main idea and concept development and innovation methods.

The student has an expertise of planning methodology typical for animation, understands the particular phases of planning, their connections and system and how to implement these in their own creative activities.

The student has a high-level of aesthetic and critical sense and has established taste.

Ability (by completing the subject, the student will acquire the following abilities):

During their design work the student forms a fundamental professional opinion about the concepts, processes and results and can have critical thinking.

By using creative, intuitive and analytical methods the student steps out of the usual frameworks and develops new concepts and innovative solutions.

The student keeps the ethical and copyright norms and applies their knowledge in compliance with the professional requirements in different institutional frameworks as well.

Attitude (the student's perception of the elements of the subject):

In their professional work the student is motivated and committed, their creative activities done within professional frameworks are experimental and innovative.

During their professional work the student endeavours to create original pieces of art by using their own creativity independently or as part of a team and endeavours to be innovative.

The student participates in creating or shaping projects in an open and communicative way.

Autonomy and Responsibility the student's involvement in learning process is developing by):

In professional questions the student can get informed independently, has established an own taste and a professional opinion.

In interdisciplinary activities the student acts in an autonomous and responsible way.

The student recognizes that their creative work fits into a given professional community and professional norm system.

SUMMARY OF THE CONTENT OF THE SUBJECT

The course broadens students' visual and conceptual approach by providing knowledge of the cultural-historical, stylistic, informational, and technical aspects of motion typography. Students apply the theoretical knowledge acquired during lectures in practical exercises, enabling them to use it across all areas of moving image art.

The course focuses on the design and execution of titles and captions for documentaries, short fiction films, and animated films, as well as the creation of infographics, with particular attention to the specific characteristics of each subject and genre.

The curriculum also includes movie title analysis and computer-based practical exercises.

LIST OF THE SUBJECT'S PLANNED TOPICS IN ACCORDANCE WITH THE SCHEDULE OF CLASSES:

Week (class)	Topic
1.	The concept of typography. Writing as the most complex system of symbols. Prehistory of writing. Computer practice: simple text, the text layer. Artwork analysis.
2.	Pictographic writing and the ideogram. Letter morphology, letter anatomy. Computer practice: text properties. Artwork analysis.
3.	Composite writing and phonetic writing. Ancient roots and Gothic script. Classification of letters: type, typeface family. Computer practice: text transformations. Artwork analysis.
4.	Styles of typographic animation. Analysis of iconic film titles and advertisements. Computer practice: animating texts of different styles with matching animation, especially the digital recreation of manually styled text effects.

5.	Dynamic typography, timing, and typographic hierarchy in motion. Computer practice: understanding the role of timing and rhythm in typographic animation.
6.	Transitions, image transitions. Computer practice: animating transitions between two texts using different methods.
7.	Special characters. Methods of formatting text bodies, hierarchy of spacing. Computer practice: applying effects.
8.	Use of 3D in After Effects, moving letters and texts in space. Computer practice: spatial animation of text.
9.	Integrated typography. Computer practice: inserting text into an existing scene
10.	Application of supplementary typographic elements. Diegetic and non-diegetic captions. Functionality and aesthetics. Common mistakes in digital typography. Computer practice: complex typographic tasks.
11.	Consultation on practical assignments. Preparation for the end-of-semester presentation.

STUDENT'S TASKS AND PLANNED LEARNING ACTIVITIES:

Applying lecture content during computer-based practical sessions.
 Making focused choices between alternatives based on predefined criteria.
 Using acquired knowledge to create creative work.
 Confident and critical use of information and communication technologies (ICT).
 Responsible use of information and interactive media.
 Interest in participating in communities and networks with cultural, social, and/or professional aims.

PRODUCTS THAT MAY BECOME PART OF THE STUDENT'S PORTFOLIO:

Design and production of short motion typography works and titles for moving image works across different media and genres, with attention to their specific aesthetic, conceptual, and technical characteristics.

EVALUATION OF THE SUBJECT:

At least 45 second long animated short film with sound effects.

EVALUATION OF THE SUBJECT:

Criteria for grading:

- class activity, attendance, consultation
- thoughtfulness, quality, validity of the work produced, plans
- independent work
- content, documentation and quality of the presentation
- timely completion of assignments

Evaluation, rating:

Excellent (5): 91-100%

Good (4): 76-90%

Satisfactory (3): 61-75%

Pass (2): 51-65%

Fail (1): 0-50%

Components of the semester grade mark:

Professional, practical knowledge (30%)

- Use of tools
- Use of software
- Workflow planning

Theoretical knowledge (15%)

- Problem raising
- Conclusions

Creative skills (30%)

- Individual creativity
- Attention to details
- Commitment

Soft skills (25%)

- Cooperation
- Contributing skills
- Flexibility
- Communication
- Presentation
- Self-assessment

The assessment will be based on the work completed and the documentation and oral presentation of the work at the mid-term exam. The student receives a grade and an oral assessment, with self-reflection practices during the semester.

2-5 items of obligatory and recommended sources:

OBLIGATORY READING LIST:

- *Big type : graphic design and identities with typographic emphasis.* Counter-print, 2023
- Braha, Yael: *Creative motion graphic titling for film, video, and the web.* Focal Press, c2011

RECOMMENDED READING LIST:

- Gautier, Damien: *Design, typography, etc. : a handbook.* Niggli, cop. 2018

FURTHER SUPPORT FOR LEARNING: :

<http://www.artofthetitle.com/>

<http://www.watchthetitles.com/>